

FIELD LIBRARY / ACTION CHECKLIST

Emergency alerts

COMMUNICATIONS / EDITION 2026-10-02

QUICK ANSWER / START HERE

Check an official alert for your exact location, hazard, timing and required action. Enable emergency alerts on your phone and add local emergency management notifications. Keep a battery radio as backup rather than relying on one app.

Do now.

☐**Enable phone alerts**

01

Review emergency notification settings and keep the phone charged.

☐**Add local channels**

02

Sign up with your county or city emergency management office and utility.

☐**Use weather backup**

03

For weather hazards, use NOAA Weather Radio or your local official warning service.

☐**Read the action**

04

Distinguish preparation notices from instructions to shelter or evacuate.

Keep the plan moving.

IF HELP IS UNAVAILABLE

Treat direct signs of danger as a reason to act even if an alert has not arrived. Compare a battery-radio bulletin with another independently obtained source when possible. Record the place and time; an old screenshot can be dangerously misleading.

Watch for.

Alerts can be delayed or missed. Act on obvious immediate danger and natural warning signs.

People & practical needs.

Use one agreed check-in message and time so several people do not drain batteries repeating the same search. Share updates privately and include the time and location

Next decision.

Write down local frequencies and contact information. Test devices and accessibility features with your household.

YOUR SITUATION / PRIVATE WORKSHEET

TIME / LOCATION / CHANGING CONDITIONS

PEOPLE / ACCESS OR MEDICAL NEEDS

SOURCES / SCOPE / LIMITS

Source-linked civilian guidance, not independent clinical or specialist certification. U.S. references; emergency numbers and services differ. Training and product instructions remain essential.

[Emergency alerts · official guidance](#)

Full guide: <https://ospreyzero.com/preparedness/emergency-alerts/>